# CONTRACT CHECKLIST

Five clauses every freelance contract needs. Check each one before you sign or send.

- [ ] **Scope**
  Exactly what's included, and what isn't.
  **Example:** "A five-page website: Home, About, Services, Reviews, Contact. Copywriting and photography are not included."

- [ ] **Revisions**
  How many rounds, and what extra rounds cost.
  **Example:** "Two rounds of revisions per page. Additional rounds are billed at $__ per hour."

- [ ] **Payment**
  50% up front, the rest on delivery, with due dates.
  **Example:** "50% deposit to begin. Remaining 50% due on launch, payable within 14 days."

- [ ] **Ownership**
  Rights transfer when the final invoice is paid.
  **Example:** "All rights to the final design transfer to the client once the final invoice is paid in full."

- [ ] **Kill fee**
  What you're owed if they cancel partway through.
  **Example:** "If the project is cancelled after work begins, the deposit is non-refundable and completed work is billed at $__."

## WHEN THEY SAY "I CAN GET IT CHEAPER"

**"He probably can, and that might be the right call. *What made you reach out to me?*"**

Don't defend your value and don't drop your price. Listen: their answer is your value, in their words. If the budget really is lower, cut the scope, not the price.

## RED FLAGS: PASS ON THE PROJECT

- They can't explain the problem they want solved.
- They haggle before you've started.
- They want free samples to "see if you're a fit," including in a hiring process.

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Not legal advice. Have a lawyer look at your template once.